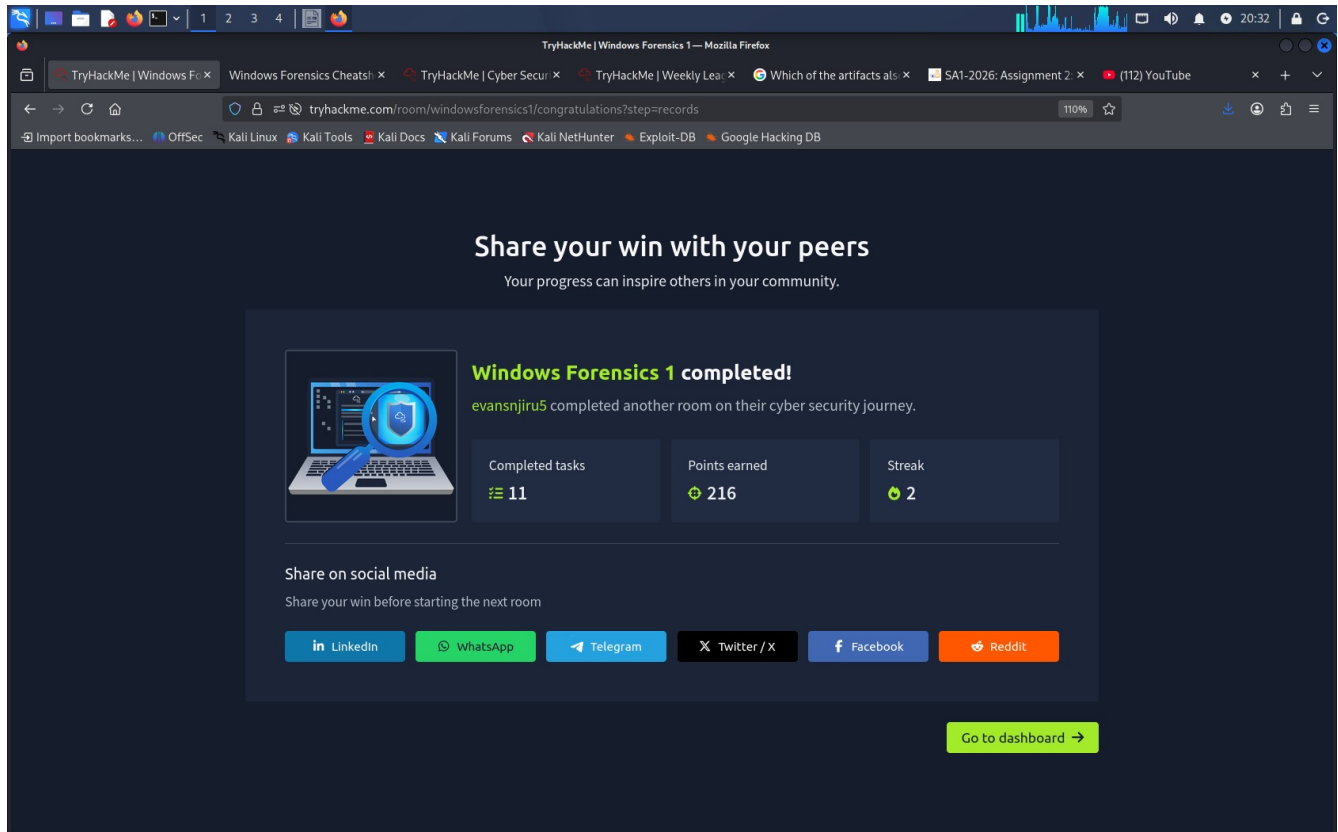


NAME: Alex Mbogo
GMAIL: evansnjiru5@gmail.com
ADMISSION NUMBER: ADC-CSS02-25064

Module: Windows Forensics 1

Module link

Module Badge



The screenshot shows a Mozilla Firefox browser window with the URL `tryhackme.com/room/windowsforensics1/congratulations?step=records`. The page has a dark theme and displays a congratulatory message for completing the 'Windows Forensics 1' room. The message includes an icon of a laptop with a magnifying glass, the title 'Windows Forensics 1 completed!', and a sub-message stating 'evansnjiru5 completed another room on their cyber security journey.' Below this, three statistics are shown: 'Completed tasks' (11), 'Points earned' (216), and 'Streak' (2). A section titled 'Share on social media' encourages sharing the win before starting the next room, with buttons for LinkedIn, WhatsApp, Telegram, Twitter/X, Facebook, and Reddit. A green button at the bottom right says 'Go to dashboard →'.

TryHackMe | Windows Forensics 1 — Mozilla Firefox

tryhackme.com/room/windowsforensics1/congratulations?step=records

Share your win with your peers

Your progress can inspire others in your community.

Windows Forensics 1 completed!

evansnjiru5 completed another room on their cyber security journey.

Completed tasks	Points earned	Streak
11	216	2

Share on social media

Share your win before starting the next room

LinkedIn WhatsApp Telegram Twitter / X Facebook Reddit

Go to dashboard →

Windows Forensics 1

Registry Hives: Understanding the five main root keys (like HKLM and HKCU) and the physical location of registry hive files in C:\Windows\System32\Config.

- **Offline Analysis:** Learning how to acquire registry hives from a suspect system and analyze them using forensic tools without modifying the original data.
- **Forensic Artifacts:** Identifying specific registry keys that track user behavior, such as RecentDocs, UserAssist, and ShellBags.

Core Forensic Artifacts Covered

Artifact Category	Description	Key Registry Path / Hive
System Info	OS version, computer name, and timezone.	SYSTEM & SOFTWARE
User Accounts	Username, login counts, and password hints.	SAM
File/Folder Usage	Tracks recently opened files and folder view settings.	NTUSER.DAT (RecentDocs)
Execution Evidence	Records of programs run, including execution count and paths.	UserAssist, ShimCache, AmCache
External Devices	History of USB devices connected to the system.	SYSTEM (USBSTOR)

Recommended Tools

The room primarily utilizes Eric Zimmerman's Tools (EZtools), which are industry standards for digital forensics:

- **Registry Explorer:** Used for loading and searching registry hives with automatic parsing of timestamps.
- **ShellBags Explorer:** Specifically designed to view the history of folders accessed by a user.
- **RegRipper:** A CLI tool for extracting specific forensic data into text reports.

Scenario:

One of the Desktops in the research lab at Organization X is suspected to have been accessed by someone unauthorized. Although they generally have only one user account per Desktop, there were multiple user accounts observed on this system. It is also suspected that the system was connected to some network drive, and a USB device was connected to the system. The triage data from the system was collected and placed on the attached VM. Can you help Organization X with finding answers to the below questions?

Note: When loading registry hives in RegistryExplorer, it will caution us that the hives are dirty. This is nothing to be afraid of. We just need to remember the little lesson about transaction logs and point RegistryExplorer to the .LOG1 and .LOG2 files with the same filename as the registry hive. It will automatically integrate the transaction logs and create a 'clean' hive. Once we tell RegistryExplorer where to save the clean hive, we can use that for our analysis and we won't need to load the dirty hives anymore. RegistryExplorer will guide you through this process.

Answer the questions below

How many user created accounts are present on the system?

✓ Correct Answer

What is the username of the account that has never been logged in?

Check

The screenshot shows a Windows VM interface. On the left, a sidebar lists 'Quick access' items: Desktop, Downloads, Documents, Pictures, EZtools, Music, Videos, OneDrive, This PC, and Network. The main window displays 'Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0'. The left pane shows a tree view of the registry, with 'C:\Windows\system...' expanded. The right pane shows a table of registry keys and values.

Key name	# values	# subkeys	Last write timestamp
ROOT	0	1	2021-11-24 18:17:47
SAM	2	3	2021-11-24 18:19:19
Domains	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Account	2	3	2021-11-25 17:05:49
Aliases	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Groups	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Users	1	8	2021-11-24 18:39:15
000000F4	2	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000000F5	2	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000000...	3	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000000F8	4	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
0000003E9	4	0	2026-03-31 15:04:52
0000003EA	3	0	2021-11-24 18:39:50
0000003EB	3	0	2021-11-24 18:39:15
Names	1	7	2021-11-24 18:39:15
Buttons	3	3	2021-11-24 18:39:15

The taskbar at the bottom shows the Windows Start button, search icon, and several application icons. The system tray on the right shows the time as 8:09 PM on 3/31/2026, and a notification icon. The VM name 'win4n6-2-badr' is visible in the bottom right corner.

TryHackMe | Windows Forensics 1 — Mozilla Firefox

TryHackMe | Windows Forensics 1 | tryhackme.com/room/windowsforensics1

Room progress (80%)

Scenario:

One of the Desktops in the research lab at Organization X is suspected to have been accessed by someone unauthorized. Although they generally have only one user account per Desktop, there were multiple user accounts observed on this system. It is also suspected that the system was connected to some network drive, and a USB device was connected to the system. The triage data from the system was collected and placed on the attached VM. Can you help Organization X with finding answers to the below questions?

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Answer the questions below

How many user created accounts are present on the system?

3

✓ Correct Answer

Need a specific next step?

Check

Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0

File Tools Options Bookmarks (1/0) View Help

Registry hives (1) Common (1)

Enter text to search...

Manage bookmarks Ctrl+B

Sync with Github

Key name

Value

Write timestamp

0 1 2021-11-24 18:17:47

2 3 2021-11-24 18:19:19

1 2 2021-11-24 18:17:47

2 3 2021-11-25 17:05:49

1 2 2021-11-24 18:17:47

2 2021-11-24 18:17:47

1 8 2021-11-24 18:39:15

2 0 2021-11-24 18:17:47

2 0 2021-11-24 18:17:47

3 0 2021-11-24 18:17:47

4 0 2021-11-24 18:17:47

4 0 2026-03-31 15:04:52

3 0 2021-11-24 18:39:50

3 0 2021-11-24 18:39:15

1 7 2021-11-24 18:39:15

3 3 2021-11-24 18:39:15

1 0 2021-11-24 18:19:19

1 0 2021-11-24 18:17:47

9 items

win4n6-2-badr

8:10 PM 3/31/2026

52min 28s

someone unauthorized. Although they generally have only one user account per Desktop, there were multiple user accounts observed on this system. It is also suspected that the system was connected to some network drive, and a USB device was connected to the system. The triage data from the system was collected and placed on the attached VM. Can you help Organization X with finding answers to the below questions?

Note: When loading registry hives in RegistryExplorer, it will caution us that the hives are dirty. This is nothing to be afraid of. We just need to remember the little lesson about transaction logs and point RegistryExplorer to the .LOG1 and .LOG2 files with the same filename as the registry hive. It will automatically integrate the transaction logs and create a 'clean' hive. Once we tell RegistryExplorer where to save the clean hive, we can use that for our analysis and we won't need to load the dirty hives anymore. RegistryExplorer will guide you through this process.

Answer the questions below

How many user created accounts are present on the system?

3

✓ Correct Answer

What is the username of the account that has never been logged in?

thm-user2

Check

the password hint for the user THM-4n6?

win4n6-2-badr

Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0

File Tools Options Bookmarks (1/0) View Help

Registry hives (1) Available bookmarks (1/0)

Enter text to search... Find

Key name	# values	# subkeys	Last write timestamp
ROOT	0	1	2021-11-24 18:17:47
SAM	2	3	2021-11-24 18:19:19
Domains	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Account	2	3	2021-11-25 17:05:49
Aliases	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Groups	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Users	1	8	2021-11-24 18:39:15
000000F4	2	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000000F5	2	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000000F7	3	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000000F8	4	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000000E9	4	0	2026-03-31 15:04:52
000000EA	3	0	2021-11-24 18:39:50
000000EB	3	0	2021-11-24 18:39:15
Names	1	7	2021-11-24 18:39:15
Admini...	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Defa...	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Guest	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
THM...	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
thm-u...	1	0	2021-11-24 18:36:29
thm-u...	1	0	2021-11-24 18:39:15
WDAT...	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Buttons	3	3	2021-11-24 18:39:15
LastSkuUpgrade	1	0	2021-11-24 18:19:19
RXACT	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47

Key: SAM\Domains\Account\Users\Names\thm-user2 Value: (default) Collapse all hives

Selected hive: SAM Last write: 2021-11-24 18:39:15 1 of 1 values shown (100.00%) Load complete Hidden keys: 0 2

8:13 PM 3/31/2026

49min 34s

Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0

File Tools Options Bookmarks (30/0) View Help

Load hive Ctrl+O

Live system

Unload all hives Alt+U

Project

Export 'Registry hives'

Exit

Console

Control Panel

Environment

ELUDC

Keyboard Layout

Microsoft

Network

Printers

SOFTWARE

System

Associated deleted records

ROOT

Unassociated deleted records

Startmenu

UrlAssociations

shell

Unassociated deleted values

Default NTUSER.DAT

Default UserClass.dat

Public NTUSER.DAT

Public UserClass.dat

THM-4n6 NTUSER.DAT

THM-4n6 UserClass.dat

thm-user NTUSER.DAT

thm-user UserClass.dat

Value Name Value Type Data Value Slack Is Deleted Data Record Reallocated

Key: ROOT

Selected hive: ntuser.dat Last write: 2026-03-31 15:04:53 Key contains no values Load complete

Type here to search

win4n6-2-badr

8:33 PM 3/31/2026

29min 27s

TryHackMe | Cyber Security Training — Mozilla Firefox

TryHackMe | Windows Fo x TryHackMe | Cyber Securi x TryHackMe | Weekly Leag x Which of the artifacts als: x SA1-2026: Assignment 2: x New Tab

tryhackme.com/fullscreen-vms/0

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Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0

File Tools Options Bookmarks (1/0) View Help

Registry hives (1) Available bookmarks (1/0)

Enter text to search... Find

Key name	# values	# subkeys	Last write timestamp
C:\Windows\system32\config\SAM			
ROOT	0	1	2021-11-24 18:17:47
SAM	2	3	2021-11-24 18:19:19
Domains	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Account	2	3	2021-11-25 17:05:49
Aliases	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Groups	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Users	1	8	2021-11-24 18:39:15
000001F4	2	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000001F5	2	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000001F7	3	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000001F8	4	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
000003E9	4	0	2026-03-31 15:04:52
000003EA	3	0	2021-11-24 18:39:50
000003EB	3	0	2021-11-24 18:39:15
Names	1	7	2021-11-24 18:39:15
Administrator	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
DefaultAccount	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Guest	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
THM-4n6	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
thm-user	1	0	2021-11-24 18:36:29
thm-user2	1	0	2021-11-24 18:39:15
WDAGUtilityAccount	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Builtin	3	3	2021-11-24 18:39:15
LastShuUpgrade	1	0	2021-11-24 18:19:19
RXACT	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47

Key: SAM\Domains\Account\Users\Names\THM-4n6

Selected hive: SAM Last write: 2021-11-24 18:17:47 1 of 1 values shown (100.00%) Load complete

Type here to search

win4n6-2-badr

19min 43s

Values

Drag a column header here to group by that column

Value Name	Value Type	Data	Value Slack	Is Deleted	Data Record Reallocated
(default)	RegUnknown	00-00-00-00			

Type viewer Binary viewer

Value name (default)

Value type RegUnknown (0x3E9, 1001 decimal)

Value 00-00-00-00

Raw value 00-00-00-00

Value: (default) Collapse all hives

Hidden keys: 0 16

8:43 PM 3/31/2026

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tryhackme.com/fullscreen-vms/0

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Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0

File Tools Options Bookmarks (1/0) View Help

Registry hives (1) Available bookmarks (1/0)

Enter text to search... Find

Key name	# values	# subkeys	Last write timestamp
C:\Windows\system32\config\SAM			
ROOT	0	1	2021-11-24 18:17:47
SAM	2	3	2021-11-24 18:19:19
Domains	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Account	2	3	2021-11-25 17:05:49
Aliases	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Groups	1	2	2021-11-24 18:17:47
Users	1	8	2021-11-24 18:39:15
Builtin	3	3	2021-11-24 18:39:15
LastShuUpgrade	1	0	2021-11-24 18:19:19
RXACT	1	0	2021-11-24 18:17:47

Key: SAM\Domains\Account\Users

Selected hive: SAM Last write: 2021-11-24 18:39:15 1 of 1 values shown (100.00%) Load complete

Type here to search

win4n6-2-badr

1h 16min 0s

Values User accounts

Drag a column header here to group by that column

Us...	Inv...	Tot...	Cr...	Las...	Las...	Las...	Ex...	Us...	Full...	Gr...	Co...	Us...	Ho...	Int...	Ac...	Ho...	Pa...	Te...	No...	Mn...	Int...	Wo...	Pa...	Aut...
1001	0	30	20...	20...	20...	20...	THM-4n6	coun	Admi	nistr	ators													
1002	0	2	20...	20...			thm-user	null	User	s														
1003	0	0	20...				thm-user2	null	User	s														

Total rows: 7 Export ?

Type viewer Binary viewer

Value name (default)

Value type RegLink

Value

Raw value

Value: (default) Collapse all hives

Hidden keys: 0 16

8:46 PM 3/31/2026

TryHackMe | Cyber Security Training — Mozilla Firefox

TryHackMe | Windows Fo x TryHackMe | Cyber Securi x TryHackMe | Weekly Leag x Which of the artifacts als x SAI-2026: Assignment 2 x New Tab

tryhackme.com/fullscreen-vms/0

Import bookmarks... OffSec Kali Linux Kali Tools Kali Docs Kali Forums Kali NetHunter Exploit-DB Google Hacking DB

Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0

File Tools Options Bookmarks (30/0) View Help

Registry hives (2) Available bookmarks (32/0)

Enter text to search... Find

Key name	# values	# subkeys	Last write timestamp
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\RecentDocs	18	0	2026-03-31 15:28:10
FeatureUsage	1	5	2022-01-04 16:16:59
FileExts	0	203	2026-03-31 15:28:10
HideDesktopIcons	0	1	2021-11-24 18:18:58
LogonStats	2	0	2021-11-24 18:23:37
LowRegistry	0	0	2021-11-24 18:23:43
MenuOrder	0	1	2021-11-24 18:19:54
Modules	0	3	2021-11-24 18:25:44
MountPoints2	0	5	2021-11-24 18:27:04
OperationStatusManager	1	0	2021-11-24 18:26:02
Package Installation	1	0	2022-01-04 16:15:54
RecentDocs	18	0	2026-03-31 15:28:10
.DAT	2	0	2026-03-31 15:26:00
.DAT_clean	2	0	2026-03-31 15:28:10
.ps1	2	0	2021-11-24 18:18:48
.txt	3	0	2026-03-31 15:19:02
.xml	2	0	2021-11-30 10:56:21
Folder	8	0	2026-03-31 15:26:00
Ribbon	2	0	2021-11-24 18:20:02
RunMRU	0	0	2021-11-24 18:18:48
SearchPlatform	0	1	2021-11-24 18:18:40
Shell Folders	31	0	2021-11-24 18:23:47
Shutdown	1	0	2025-11-15 13:08:30
StarPage	2	0	2021-11-24 18:20:02
StartupApproved	0	2	2022-01-04 15:53:35
Streams	0	1	2021-11-24 18:20:02
StuckRects3	1	0	2026-03-31 15:05:52
TableMode	1	0	2021-11-24 18:24:10

Key: SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\RecentDocs\.

Selected hive: ntuser.dat Last write: 2026-03-31 15:19:02 3 of 3 values shown (100.00%) Copied Last write time to clipboard

Type here to search

win4n6-2-badr

1h 6min 2s

Extension	Value Name	Target Name	Link Name	Mru Position	Opened On	Extension Last Opened
.txt	1	2021-12-01T130817_Co	2021-12-01T130817_Co	0	2026-03-31 15:19:02	
.txt	0	ChangeLog.txt	ChangeLog.lnk	1		

Total rows: 2

Type viewer

00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 0A 0B 0C 0D 0E 0F 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18

00000000 01 00 00 00 00 00 00 00 FF FF FF FF

Current offset: 0 (0x0) Bytes selected: 0 (0x0)

Data interpreter

Value: MRUListEx Collapse all hives

Hidden keys: 0

TryHackMe | Cyber Security Training — Mozilla Firefox

TryHackMe | Windows Fo x TryHackMe | Cyber Securi x TryHackMe | Weekly Leag x Which of the artifacts als x SAI-2026: Assignment 2 x New Tab

tryhackme.com/fullscreen-vms/0

Import bookmarks... OffSec Kali Linux Kali Tools Kali Docs Kali Forums Kali NetHunter Exploit-DB Google Hacking DB

Registry Explorer v1.6.0.0

File Tools Options Bookmarks (30/0) View Help

Registry hives (1) Available bookmarks (31/0)

Enter text to search... Find

Key name	# values	# subkeys	Last write timestamp
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\RecentDocs	9	4	2021-12-01 13:00:34
CIDOpen	0	1	2021-12-01 13:00:34
CLSID	0	5	2021-12-01 13:00:34
ComDlg32	0	3	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Desktop	0	1	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Discardable	0	1	2021-12-01 13:00:34
DiskSpaceChecking	2	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
FeatureUsage	1	4	2021-12-01 13:00:34
FileExts	0	198	2021-12-01 13:00:34
HideDesktopIcons	0	1	2021-12-01 13:00:34
LogonStats	2	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
LowRegistry	0	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
MenuOrder	0	1	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Modules	0	3	2021-12-01 13:00:34
MountPoints2	0	5	2021-12-01 13:00:34
OperationStatusManager	1	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Package Installation	1	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
RecentDocs	9	4	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Ribbon	2	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
RunMRU	0	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
SearchPlatform	0	1	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Shell Folders	31	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Shutdown	1	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
StarPage	2	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
Streams	0	1	2021-12-01 13:00:34
StuckRects3	1	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34
TableMode	1	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34

Key: SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\RecentDocs

Selected hive: NTUSER.DAT_clean Last write: 2021-12-01 13:00:34 9 of 9 values shown (100.00%) Load complete

Type here to search

win4n6-2-badr

47min 12s

Extension	Value Name	Target Name	Link Name	Mru Position	Opened On	Extension Last Opened
RecentDocs	7	EZtools	EZtools.lnk	0	2021-12-01 13:00:34	
RecentDocs	6	Settings	Settings.lnk	1		2021-11-30 10:56:23
RecentDocs	5	WallpaperSettings.xml	WallpaperSettings.lnk	2		2021-11-30 10:56:21
RecentDocs	4	System and Security	System and Security.lnk	3		
RecentDocs	3	System and Security	System and Security.lnk	4		
RecentDocs	1	KAPE	KAPE.lnk	5		
RecentDocs	0	Get-KAPEUpdate.ps1	Get-KAPEUpdate.lnk	6		2021-11-24 18:18:48
RecentDocs	2	ChangeLog.txt	ChangeLog.lnk	7		2021-11-24 18:18:48
Folder	2	Settings	Settings.lnk	0	2021-11-30 10:56:23	
Folder	1	System and Security	System and Security.lnk	1		
Folder	0	KAPE	KAPE.lnk	2		
.xml	0	WallpaperSettings.xml	WallpaperSettings.lnk	0	2021-11-30 10:56:21	
.txt	0	ChangeLog.txt	ChangeLog.lnk	0	2021-11-24 18:18:48	
.ps1	0	Get-KAPEUpdate.ps1	Get-KAPEUpdate.lnk	0	2021-11-24 18:18:48	

Total rows: 14

Type viewer

00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 0A 0B 0C 0D 0E 0F 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18

00000000 07 00 00 00 06 00 00 00 05 00 00 00 04 00 00 00 03 00 00 00 01 00 00 00 00

00000019 00 00 00 02 00 00 00 FF FF FF FF

Current offset: 0 (0x0) Bytes selected: 0 (0x0)

Data interpreter

Value: MRUListEx Collapse all hives

Hidden keys: 0

